

| PureView                                | ViewSonic             | Winsonic     |
|-----------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------|
| PV 17C                                  | VA712                 | L17X         |
| 0.264                                   | 0.264                 | 0.264        |
| 250                                     | 380                   | 300          |
| 500:1                                   | 350:1                 | 400:1        |
| 1280x1024                               | 1280x1024             | 1280x1024    |
| 25                                      | 8                     | NA           |
| 41.5x39x14                              | 38.6x41.1x17.7        | 41x42.5x20.4 |
| 4.5                                     | 4.3                   | NA           |
| ✗                                       | ✗                     | ✗            |
| ✓/2                                     | ✓/1W                  | ✓            |
| ✓                                       | ✓                     | ✓            |
| ✗/✓                                     | ✗/Y                   | ✗/✓          |
| ✗                                       | ✗                     | ✓            |
| ✗                                       | ✗                     | ✗            |
| ✗                                       | ✗                     | ✗            |
| 40                                      | 60                    | NA           |
| D-Sub, Stereo pin                       | D-Sub, stereo pin     | D-Sub        |
| User guide, drivers, Colorific software | Quick start guide, CD | NA           |
| 3                                       | 3.75                  | 2.75         |
| 3.75                                    | 4                     | 3.25         |
| 4.75                                    | 5                     | 2.5          |
| 4.5                                     | 5                     | 2.5          |
| 4.75                                    | 4.375                 | 2.5          |
| 3.375                                   | 3.25                  | 1.5          |
| 3.625                                   | 3.625                 | 1.5          |
| 3.625                                   | 3.625                 | 1.5          |
| 4                                       | 4                     | 2            |
| 3                                       | 4                     | 1.75         |
| 3.5                                     | 4                     | 2            |
| 3.25                                    | 3.5                   | 1.75         |
| 3.25                                    | 3.625                 | 1.75         |
| 3.25                                    | 3.5                   | 1.5          |
| 2.875                                   | 3                     | 1.75         |
| 3.625                                   | 4                     | 2            |
| 2.75                                    | 2.875                 | 0.75         |
| 0.5                                     | 0.75                  | 0.25         |
| 2.75                                    | 2.5                   | 0.75         |
| 152.5                                   | 155                   | 75           |
| 135                                     | 145                   | 75           |
| 4.125                                   | 4                     | 1.5          |
| <b>62.36</b>                            | <b>64.04</b>          | <b>63.10</b> |
| 7.60                                    | 5.40                  | 4.78         |
| 43.56                                   | 46.19                 | 41.85        |
| 11.20                                   | 12.44                 | 16.47        |
| 25,000                                  | 22,500                | 16,999       |

shift, but not to the extent that it could cause eye strain.

Level shift, if high, can be a big problem in Photoshop-like applications, where there are often light and dark areas adjacent to each other.

### Text-Colour Combination

In this test, we checked for a monitor reproduced coloured fonts on backgrounds of different colours.

LCDs have red, green and blue sub-pixels that make up a pixel. When coloured text, say magenta, is displayed on a grey background, you can easily identify the black space between two magenta dots, making the font look serrated.

Of the 15-inchers, the Umax returned impressive overall results—it had no problems with magenta fonts. The CMV CT-529A and the Winsonic L1562S, on the other hand, returned poor results: both yellow and magenta fonts appeared like a collection of dots.

In the 17-inch category, it was again the CMV CT-712A that returned lower-than-average results. The rest of the 17-inchers fared pretty well too.

### Intensity Levels

In this set of tests, we looked for how well the LCD monitors could display 16, 64 and 256 shades of grey (these are the ranges that the benchmark suites provide for).

The 64-Intensities test with secondary colours, and the 256-Intensities tests, are rather difficult for LCD monitors—hardly any monitor can display more than 64 shades correctly. In this, contrast and brightness play an important role, as an overly bright screen will not display shades of grey in the light region, and a dark screen will merge shades on the darker side.

All the 15-inch monitors fared well in the 16-Intensities and 64-Intensities tests for primary colours, except for a couple: the Winsonic L1562S and the LG L1530S merged a few levels on the brighter and darker sides respec-

tively. In the 256-Intensities test, the PureView PV 15C displayed thick black and white bands (meaning that it merged the shades) on either side of the spectrum. This can be a problem, especially while watching movies, where dark scenes will appear overly dark, hence snuffing out the details.

The Winsonic L17X, in the 17-inch category, scored low compared to the others in this test. This means that the user will need to manually calibrate the monitor for contrast and brightness rather than relying on the auto setting.

### Miscellaneous Tests

#### Screen Uniformity And Reverse Video Contrast

In this test, coloured text on white and two different shades of grey was used. In the 15-inch category, the S-Media was the only monitor



Philips 170S5FB/00

NEC MultiSync LCD1770NXM

that suffered in screen uniformity: it displayed several shades of grey. The reverse video contrast test was easy for all the 15-inches; they all passed it without much variation in quality.

Among the 17-inch monitors, the Winsonic, HCL and NEC scored lowest: there was clearly-visible variation throughout, in the screen uniformity test. The Philips 170s returned solid results, with a very

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